

Life cycles

All living things go through stages of growth. Baby animals are born or hatch from eggs, and new plants sprout from the soil. They grow, become adults, and eventually have young of their own. This is called a **life cycle**.

Human life cycle

Like all other animals, humans have a life cycle. Our bodies change gradually as we journey through life, slowly turning us from babies into **adults**.

1. Baby

When you're a baby, you're very small and fragile, and you sleep a lot. You need to be cared for all the time.

2. Toddler

As a toddler, you learn to walk, talk, and feed yourself—usually messily! You grow teeth, called baby (or milk) teeth.

3. Child

You grow quickly, get stronger, and develop new skills, such as reading and writing. Adult teeth replace your baby teeth.

4. Teenager

When you're a teenager, chemicals called **hormones** tell your body to start changing from a child into an adult.

5. Adult

You're fully grown, but you can keep learning new things. You are now able to have children of your own.

